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We check out what goes on in the innards of a Superbike.

Feature

One of the reasons electric sometimes seems to lose favour is the fact that electricity itself isn't clean. Many power stations themselves run on polluting fuels, and thus seem to defeat the whole purpose of the electric car. In this light, alternative fuel choices start to look more favourable, especially since they are more compatible with the

systems already in place.

An electric car is at best as clean as the power-supply station for the area where it is charged. However, with efforts underway to make the power generation stations pollution free, they cannot just be dismissed off-hand. For early adopters, electric cars are already available, even in India, with the Reva; a compact two-seater car which comes at an affordable price.

Electric cars use, quite unsurprisingly, electric motors which are powered by on-board batteries. One might wonder why it is so difficult to make electric cars, when the essential



Yes they exist!

Flying Cars

Flying cars have always been a dream, but don't expect them to look anything like the cars from *Back to the Future*. They are rather more like small aircraft that can

travel on roads. Examples are *Parajet Skycar* to be available soon for (£50,000 or around Rs. 40 lakh), and the X-Hawk, a personal helicopter of sorts available for US\$3 million (around Rs. 50crore) in 2010.

Amphibian cars

They are here today, although used more by the military. Still, amuse yourself with the thought that you could now avoid the traffic jam by directly cutting across that pesky river.